

ETIS

Student Cheat Sheet / Quick Reference

Day-to-day guide for evidence, reviews, recommendations, checkpoints, history, and common problems

Audience Students using ETIS Engineering Studio

Purpose Give students a compact reference they can keep open while working in Studio.

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EXECUTIVE OVERVIEW

Use repository evidence to have a senior-engineer-style conversation, make a defensible decision, and own the consequences. The AI is not the responsible engineer - you are.

1. Normal path

My Team healthy	Inspect evidence	Choose review	Discuss / challenge	State position if ready	Complete / revisit
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2. Which review should I choose?

Review	Choose it when	Best opening move
Board Review	Normal phase-aware developmental review.	Let the board choose the highest-value current challenge.
Focused Review	You have a specific decision, artifact, risk, PR, architecture, or AI-use question.	Name the engineering subject precisely and bring the relevant evidence.
Review Findings	You want to work directly with existing findings.	Select 1-3 related findings; ask, challenge, resolve, accept/defer.

3. How to talk to the reviewer

- Ask questions; do not pretend you understand a challenge you do not understand.
- Say what you know, what you do not know, and what evidence you would seek next.
- Challenge the reviewer with evidence when its interpretation is wrong or incomplete.
- Explain tradeoffs, consequences, constraints, ownership, and change triggers - not only implementation details.
- Use Give me a nudge when stuck; use Build my recommendation only when a consequential decision is actually forming.
- Do not optimize for agreement or polished wording. Engineering meaning matters more than English fluency.

4. Current recommendation

Posture	Meaning
Not ready yet	Keep reasoning; identify missing evidence or authority.
Continue	Proceed on the current path.
Continue with conditions	Proceed only within explicit conditions/guardrails.
Hold / defer	Pause the relevant decision/work until evidence/uncertainty improves.
Reject this path	Recommend a different direction.
Request evidence / escalate	The decision exceeds current evidence or authority.

NOT THE SAME AS COMMITTING

Current recommendation is revisable. Use the later recommendation action only when you are prepared to defend a consequential position.

5. Evidence and findings

Term	Remember
FACT	Frozen repository-derived evidence. The review should not rewrite it.
REVIEW finding	Interpretation of FACT; you may discuss, challenge, resolve, accept/defer, or seek correction.
Strength	Evidence-supported work already defensible.
Equivalent evidence	Different artifact form that serves the intended engineering purpose.
Starter scaffold	Provided structure; not proof that your team performed the work.
Coverage	How much expected/equivalent current-phase evidence is visible - not a course grade.

6. Checkpoints, commits, and old history

- Starting a review automatically freezes the current evidence snapshot - that frozen snapshot is the review checkpoint.
- New commits do not rewrite an active or completed review.
- GitHub is where you inspect exact commit, branch, PR, and tag history.
- Review History is where you revisit earlier engineering conversations against the frozen evidence that existed then.
- Resume an Active session when you want the same conversation/snapshot; start a new review after meaningful new commits when you want a newer snapshot.
- Formal course evidence boundaries (for example a required Git tag) remain separate from developmental Studio checkpoints.

7. A strong engineering answer usually includes

- Your recommendation - or why you are not ready.
- The repository evidence that supports it.
- The important uncertainty or evidence boundary.
- The consequence/residual risk you are accepting.
- Practical conditions, constraints, or guardrails.
- Who owns follow-up.
- What evidence/event would cause you to change, lift, reject, or close the decision.

8. Fast troubleshooting

Problem	Action
Wrong GitHub account	My Team -> Change linked GitHub account.
Owner/organization authorization required	The personal owner or GitHub organization owner/admin must authorize.
Step 1 done / Step 2 pending	Check & verify repository access.
Finding seems wrong	Challenge it with evidence; use Review Findings for an existing finding.
0% / thin evidence	May mean starter scaffold or missing team-created evidence, not a broken GitHub connection.
Review looks stale after new commits	Expected for a frozen session; start a new review for a newer snapshot.
Active session already exists	Resume it if you want the same frozen-context conversation.
Stuck	Ask a question or use Give me a nudge.
Page repeatedly slow	Retry once; capture browser Network/request information and tell the instructor.

BEST HABIT

Treat the reviewer like a demanding senior engineer: ask questions, bring evidence, admit uncertainty, challenge weak interpretations, and make the decision yours.

TEAM SETUP SHORTCUT

If My Team already shows Verified team repository, do not re-onboard it. Repository trust is team-shared; move on to Engineering Evidence or Studio.